communal, framework. Hence ‘Bharatiya’ rather than ‘Hindu’—but since Mookerjee subscribed to the Savarkar idea that all Indians, strictly speaking, were Hindus, there was no great contradiction there. To Mookerjee and his followers, Hinduism was a national identity rather than a communal one and the Bharatiya Jana Sangh in effect claimed the national mantle for its Hindutva agenda.

In the two and a half decades of its existence, the Bharatiya Jana Sangh impressed itself upon the nation’s consciousness as a well-organised and effective opposition party with some able leaders, but it never came remotely close to power. Its best electoral performance was in 1967, when it won 35 seats in a right-of-centre ‘Grand Alliance’ with the liberal, pro-free enterprise Swatantra Party, which claimed 44—a total dwarfed by the 283 of the ruling Congress Party. This was the time when the concept of Hindutva received its fullest flowering under the leadership of party president Deen Dayal Upadhyaya, whose ideas, in particular his philosophy of Integral Humanism, I discuss below in some detail.

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Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyaya is undoubtedly the most significant ideologue of the contemporary Hindutva movement. Despite having served only one year (1967–1968) as president of the Bharatiya Jana Sangh, the precursor party of today’s ruling BJP, before his life was prematurely cut short, Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyaya (1916–1968) is enjoying something of a renaissance these days. The Narendra Modi government ruling India since 2014 swears by his life and work, and there has been a proliferation of seminars and conferences discussing and dissecting his philosophy of Integral Humanism. Numerous institutions have been named after him, from the Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya Shekhawati University in Sikar (Rajasthan) to the Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Hospital, Delhi and the Pandit Deendayal Petroleum University, Gandhinagar, Gujarat. Millions of pounds of government funds have been spent on various schemes (*yojanas*) to perpetuate his name.[37] There are medical colleges, hospitals, parks and a flyover (in Bengaluru) that bear his name, not to mention the Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya National Academy of Social Security, Janakpuri, Delhi. The